

Online Latex Report Writing

OpenAI Prism

Tool	Collaboration (Free Tier)	Lock-in Risk	Best For
OpenAI Prism	Unlimited collaborators; real-time sync.	High: Service is new; terms for EDU may change.	AI-native drafting, refactoring math, and quick literature search.
Overleaf (Community)	Unlimited (if self-hosted by the university).	None: You own the server and the software instance.	Large-scale institutional use with full administrative control.
CoCalc	Unlimited; includes chat and time-travel history.	Medium: Free servers can be slower during peak hours.	Data science-heavy reports and complex mathematical computations.
Papeeria	Collaborative; integrated with Git/GitHub.	Low: Standard LaTeX files are easily exported/moved.	Students who prefer a simple UI and version control integration.
GitHub + VS Code	Unlimited via Git repositories.	Zero: Entirely local/open-source toolchain.	Advanced students; teaching industry-standard version control.

Optional: The "Ultimate" No-Fee Method: VS Code + GitHub

- If you want to completely bypass cloud providers, use a GitHub + VS Code workflow. This is free for any number of students and is the most common industry-standard practice for avoiding lock-in.
- Editor: Students use Visual Studio Code (Free) with the LaTeX Workshop extension.
- Collaboration: Use GitHub Education to host repositories. Students can collaborate on the same .tex files using "Git" version control.
- Benefits: This setup is impossible to "lock" or monetise because the tools are local and the version control is standard.